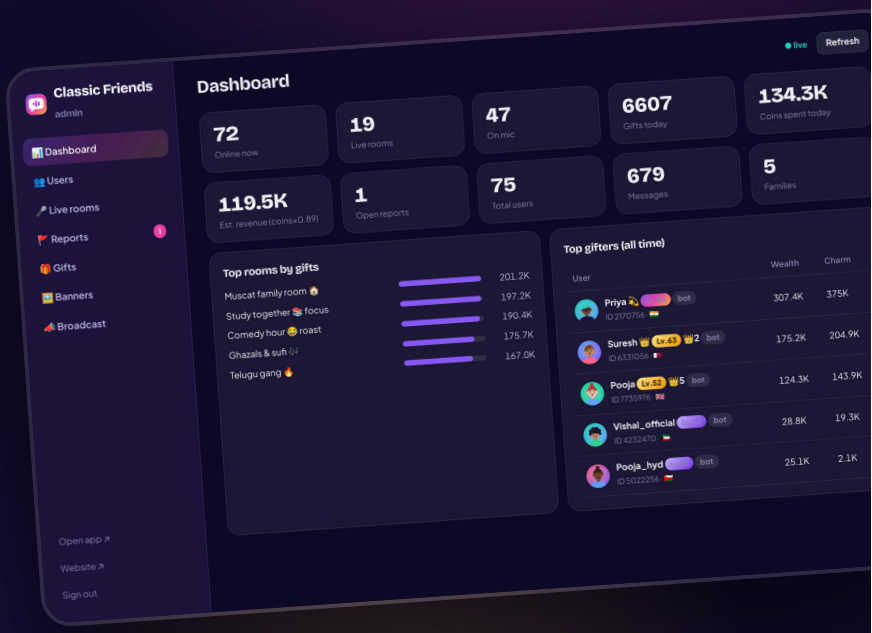
Classic Friends

Operations handbook · Version 1.0 · Internal

Admin Console Guide

How to run Classic Friends day to day: the dashboard, people, live rooms, reports, the gift catalog, banners, broadcasts and the server behind it all.



For owners, operations staff and moderators

Console address your-domain/admin/ · locally http://localhost:3000/admin/

Contents

1 What the console does 2

2 Signing in and finding your way 3

3 Dashboard 4

4 Users 6

5 Live rooms 8

6 Reports and moderation 10

7 Gift catalog 12

8 Home banners 14

9 Broadcast 15

10 Running the server 16

11 Daily, weekly and monthly routines 18

12 Economy reference 19

13 Admin API reference 21

14 Troubleshooting 22

CHAPTER 1

What the console does

The admin console is the control room for Classic Friends. It shows what is happening right now and lets a small team keep the community safe, the economy healthy and the home screen fresh.

🔐 **Security basics**

Change the default token (`classicfriends-admin`) before anyone but you can reach the server. Only open the console over **https://**. Never paste the token into chats or screenshots. Rotate it whenever a team member leaves (see Chapter 10).

📊

Dashboard

Who is online, which rooms are live, gifts and coins today, open reports, top rooms and top gifters.

👥

Users

Find anyone by name or ID. Grant coins, set VIP, ban or unban.

🎤

Live rooms

Every open room with host, people, mics and gifts. Open one, or end it.

🚩

Reports

Everything members have reported, with context. Dismiss, warn or ban.

🎁

Gift catalog

Prices, availability and new gifts.

🖼️

Banners & Broadcast

Home-screen campaigns and app-wide announcements.

1.1 Who should have access

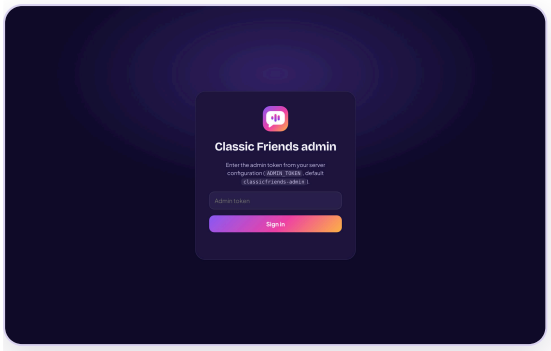
The console is protected by one admin token. Everyone who knows the token has every power on this list, so keep the circle small. A practical split for a growing team:

Role	Uses	Should not
Owner	Everything, including the server, the token, gift prices and payouts.	—
Operations	Dashboard, banners, broadcasts, gift catalog, coin grants for promotions.	Ban users without a report trail.
Moderator	Reports, users (ban/unban), live rooms (end room).	Change prices, grant coins, edit banners.
Support	Users (look up, small coin grants for refunds/compensation).	Ban, end rooms, change catalog.

CHAPTER 2

Signing in and finding your way

The console lives at `/admin/` on the same address as the app.

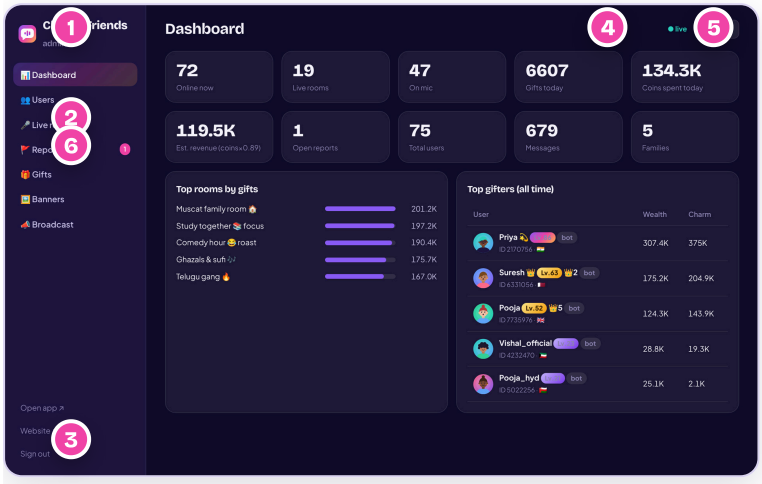


Sign-in. Paste the admin token and press Sign in. The token is remembered in this browser until you sign out.

1. Open `https://your-domain/admin/` (locally: `http://localhost:3000/admin/`).
2. Enter the admin token. It is the `ADMIN_TOKEN` value set on the server.
3. Tap `Sign in`. If the token is wrong you will see *That token was not accepted*.
4. To leave, use `Sign out` at the bottom of the sidebar. This forgets the token on this browser.

> **Bookmark the pages**
> Each page has its own address: `/admin/#users`, `/admin/#rooms`, `/admin/#reports`, `/admin/#gifts`, `/admin/#banners`, `/admin/#broadcast`.

2.1 The layout

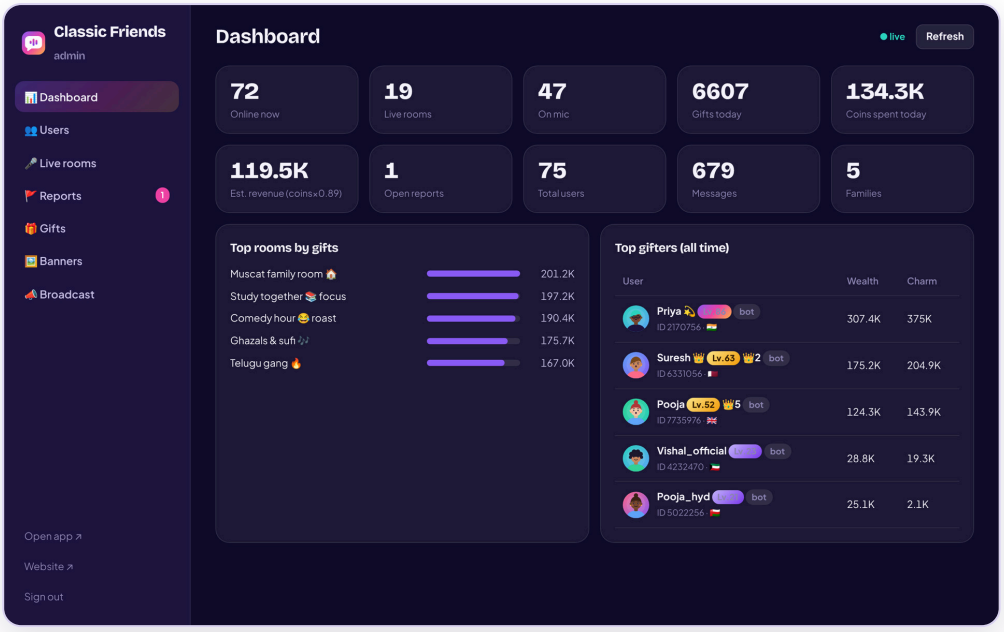


1. **Brand and home.** Tap to return to the dashboard.
2. **Navigation.** Dashboard, Users, Live rooms, Reports, Gifts, Banners, Broadcast. The pink number next to Reports is the count of open reports.
3. **Links and sign out.** Open the app or the website in a new tab; sign out of the console.
4. **Status.** ● *live* means the console is talking to the server; ● *offline* means it cannot reach it (see Troubleshooting).
5. **Refresh.** Reloads the current page immediately. Dashboard and Live rooms also refresh themselves every 10 seconds while the tab is visible.
6. **Reports badge** — a shortcut to what needs attention.

CHAPTER 3

Dashboard

A live picture of the community. Glance at it at the start and end of every shift.



Dashboard. Ten tiles, top rooms by gifts and top gifters. Refreshes every 10 seconds.

3.1 The tiles

Tile	Exactly what it counts	What to watch for
Online now	Accounts connected at this moment, including simulated people (bots) if they are enabled.	Your busiest hours — schedule broadcasts and events for them.
Live rooms	Rooms currently open.	A sudden drop can mean the server restarted.
On mic	People sitting on a mic seat across all rooms.	Low "on mic" with high "online" means rooms are quiet — nudge hosts.
Gifts today	Number of gifts sent since midnight (UTC). Resets daily.	Compare day over day after campaigns.
Coins spent today	Coins spent on gifts since midnight (UTC).	Your core economy signal.
Est. revenue	Coins spent today × 0.89 — a rough platform share after host payouts and store fees. Adjust the factor in `shared/engine.js` to match your real margin.	Treat as an estimate, not accounting.

Tile	Exactly what it counts	What to watch for
Open reports	Reports nobody has acted on yet.	Keep this at zero by the end of each shift.
Total users	All accounts ever created on this server (bots included).	Growth.
Messages	Room chat messages since the server started.	Engagement.
Families	Families that exist.	Community depth.

3.2 Top rooms and top gifters

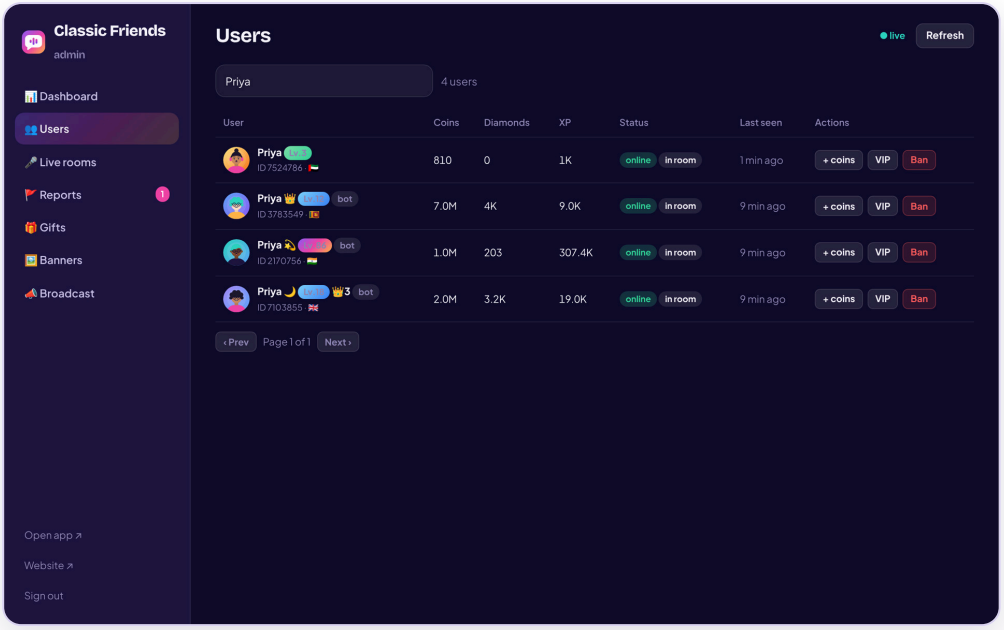
Top rooms by gifts ranks live rooms by the total coins gifted inside them since they opened; the bar is relative to the top room. **Top gifters** lists the five accounts with the most XP (coins ever sent) and their Charm (coins ever received). People marked `bot` are simulated and can be ignored for business decisions.

> 🤖 **About bots**
> Simulated people keep rooms lively while the community is small. They appear in counts and lists with a *bot* tag. Turn them off for production with `BOTS=0` (Chapter 10).

CHAPTER 4

Users

Find any account, see its balances and status, and act on it.

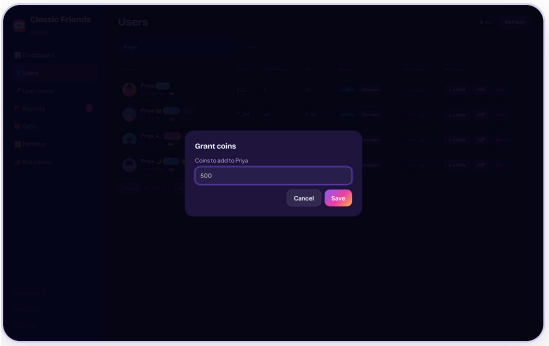


Users. Search by name or ID. 25 accounts per page, newest first.

4.1 Columns

Column	Meaning
User	Avatar, name, level badge, VIP crown and level, bot tag if simulated; below: Classic Friends ID and country.
Coins	Spendable balance.
Diamonds	Earned from gifts received; exchangeable for coins by the member.
XP	Total coins ever sent (drives level and the Wealth ranking).
Status	online connected now · offline · banned suspended · in room currently inside a room.
Last seen	Time since the account was last connected.

4.2 Actions



Grant coins. Type an amount and save. The member's balance updates instantly, even mid-room.

+ coins

Adds coins to the account. Use it for refunds, compensation after an outage, contest prizes and promotions. Enter the amount and tap **Save**. Keep a note of every grant (who, how much, why) in your team's log — the console does not keep one yet.

VIP

Sets the VIP level 0–7 directly. A level set here stays until you change it (it does not expire like a purchased VIP). Use 0 to remove VIP. Typical uses: partner hosts, agency leaders, making good on a failed purchase.

Ban / Unban

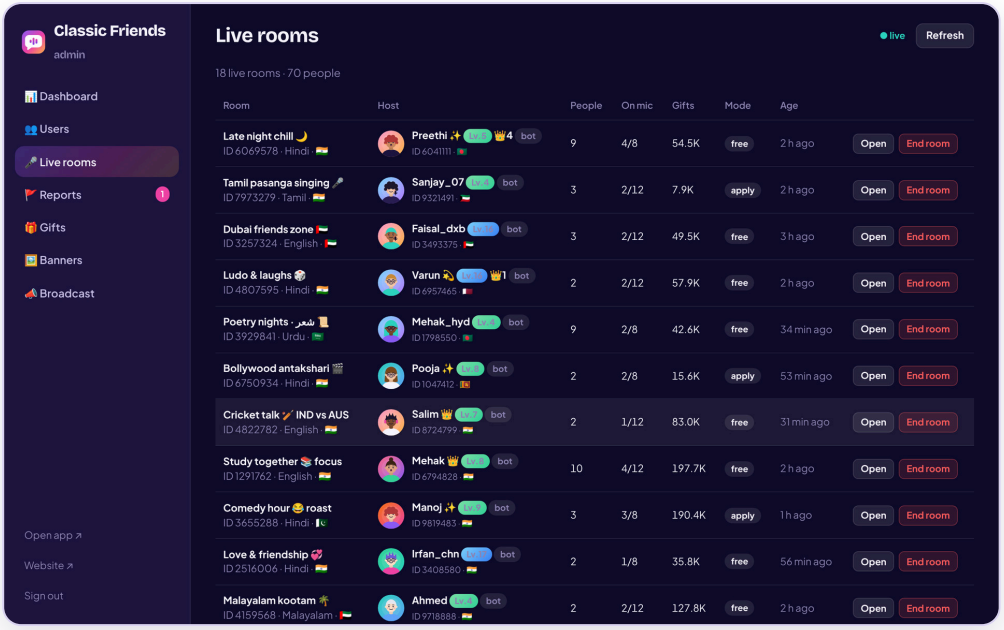
Confirm the dialog to ban. The member is removed from any room immediately, sees *Your account was suspended*, and cannot sign in again until you tap **Unban**. Banning is reversible and keeps the account's history, coins and friends.

> ⚖️ **Before you ban**
> Check the reports page for the context, note the report ID and reason, and prefer *Warned* for a first offence unless the behaviour is severe (threats, scams, sexual content, underage). See the moderation policy in Chapter 6.

CHAPTER 5

Live rooms

Every room that is open right now, who hosts it and how busy it is.



Live rooms. Refreshes every 10 seconds. The line under each room shows its ID, language, country, a lock for private rooms and ⚔️ when a PK battle is running.

Column	Meaning
Room	Name, ID, language, country, 🔒 private, ⚔️ PK running.
Host	The owner of the room (their name, level and VIP).
People	Members inside right now.
On mic	Occupied seats / total seats (8 or 12).
Gifts	Coins gifted in this room since it opened.
Mode	*free* — anyone can take a seat · *apply* — the host approves seats.
Age	How long the room has been open.

5.1 Open

Open launches the room in the app in a new tab, using whatever member account that browser is signed in with. Sign in to the app with a dedicated staff account (for example "Classic Friends Team") so hosts recognise you. Inside the room you can listen, read the chat and use the normal member tools (report, block). You do not get host powers in someone else's room — use **End room** from the console for that.

5.2 End room

End room closes the room for everyone after a confirmation. Members see *The host ended the room* and return to the home screen; the room disappears from the list. Use it for rooms that break the rules

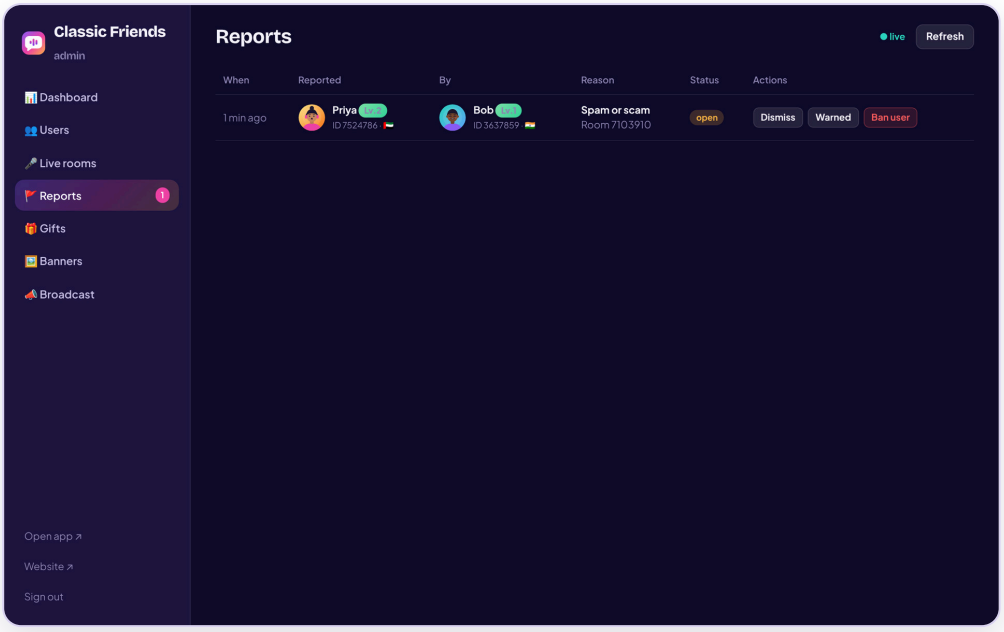
(after a warning where possible), for abandoned rooms with a disconnected host, or during an incident. There is no undo, but the host can open a new room at once.

> 📣 **Warn first**
> Send a broadcast (Chapter 9) or join the room with the staff account and write in chat before ending a busy room. Members remember how they were treated.

CHAPTER 6

Reports and moderation

Members report people from any seat, chat line, profile or private chat. Every report lands here with its context.



Reports. Newest first. Open reports show three actions; resolved ones show their outcome.

6.1 Anatomy of a report

Column	Meaning
When	Time since the report was filed.
Reported	The account being reported — the person you may act on.
By	The member who filed it. Repeated reports from one person about many others can be a sign of a grudge.
Reason	One of: Abusive language · Harassment · Spam or scam · Inappropriate content · Underage user · Other. Any extra details and the room ID appear underneath.
Status	**open** waiting for you · *resolved* dismissed · *warned* member was warned · *ban* member was banned.

6.2 Handling a report

1. **Read the context.** Reason, details and the room ID. If the room is still live, open it (Live rooms → Open) and watch for a few minutes.
2. **Check history.** Search the reported account on the Users page and look for earlier reports about them on this page.
3. **Choose an action:** `Dismiss` when nothing is wrong or there is no evidence · `Warned` when you have told the member to stop (send them a message from the staff account) · `Ban user` for severe or repeated violations — this bans immediately after a confirmation.
4. **Write it down.** Report ID, decision and reason go in the team log so the next moderator sees the pattern.

6.3 Recommended policy

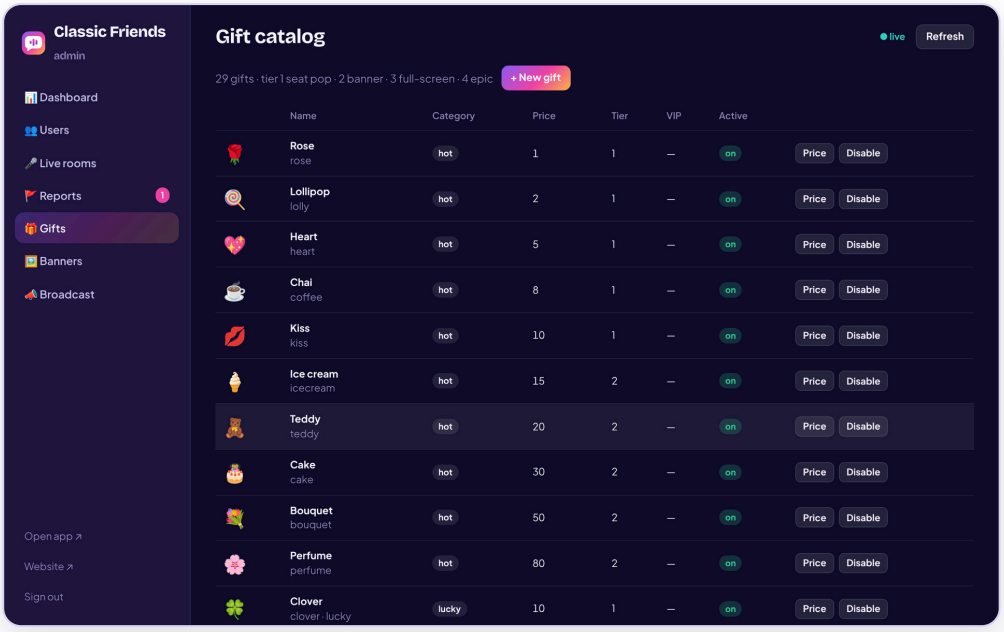
Behaviour	First time	Repeat
Rude language, spam, off-topic selling	Warn	Ban for 7 days (unban manually), then permanent
Harassment, hate, targeted bullying	Warn and end the room if the host allowed it	Permanent ban
Scams: selling coins outside the app, asking for OTPs or payment details	Permanent ban	—
Sexual content, threats, violence	Permanent ban; preserve details for authorities if needed	—
Underage user	Ban and delete personal data on request	—
False or vengeful reporting	Dismiss; warn the reporter if it repeats	Ban the reporter after repeated abuse

⏱️ **Response targets**
Look at open reports at least every 2 hours during your busy evening window and within 24 hours otherwise. Underage and scam reports come first.

CHAPTER 7

Gift catalog

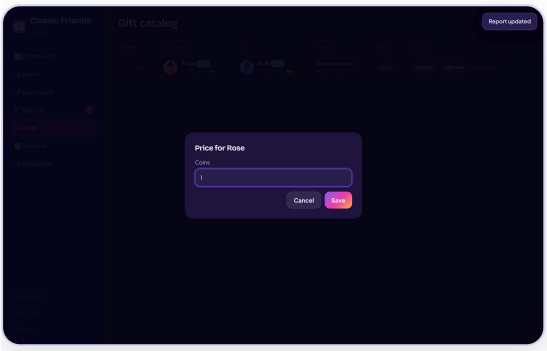
Twenty-nine gifts across four shelves. You can change prices, switch gifts on or off and add new ones without touching code.



Gift catalog. Emoji, name and ID, category, price, tier, VIP requirement and whether it is active.

Column	Meaning
Category	*hot* everyday · *lucky* can pay the sender back · *luxury* big effects · *vip* needs a VIP level.
Price	Coins the sender pays per gift.
Tier	Visual effect: 1 pops on the receiver's seat · 2 adds a fly-in and a banner · 3 fills the screen with a burst · 4 adds a screen flash and vibration.
VIP	Minimum VIP level needed to send it (VIP shelf only).
Active	*on* can be sent · *off* hidden from the panel.

7.1 Changing a price



Price dialog. Enter the new price in coins and save.

1. Tap **Price** on the gift's row.
2. Enter the new price in coins and tap **Save**.
3. The server uses the new price at once. Members see it the next time they sign in (the app loads the catalog on sign-in).

Keep the shelves readable: Hot 1–80, Lucky 10–100, Luxury 100–50,000, VIP 300–30,000. Changing tiers or VIP levels is done in `shared/catalog.js`.

7.2 Disable, enable and add gifts

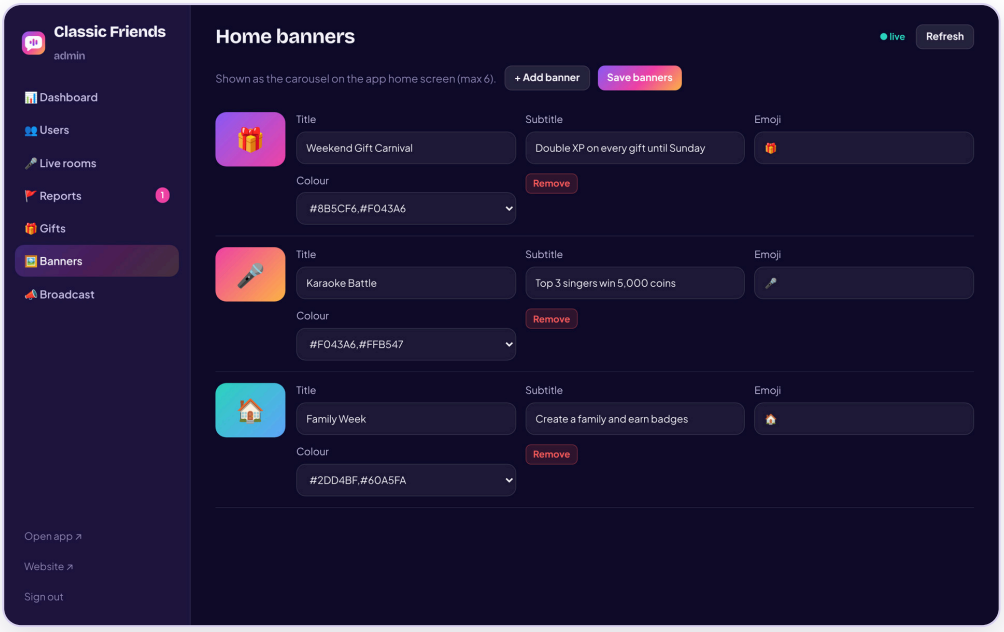
- `Disable` hides a gift from the panel without deleting it; `Enable` brings it back. Useful for seasonal gifts.
- `+ New gift` asks for a name, an emoji and a price. The tier is chosen from the price (15+ coins → banner, 500+ → full screen) and the gift goes on the Hot shelf. New gifts appear for members on their next sign-in.
- Catalog edits live in the server's memory. Make permanent changes in `shared/catalog.js` as well, or they will be lost on the next restart.

> 🎯 **Pricing that works**
> Keep a 1-coin gift (the Rose) so everyone can say hello. Put the most beautiful effect on something many people can afford (the Crown at 500). Raise luxury prices only when the top rankings are dominated by a handful of accounts.

CHAPTER 8

Home banners

The carousel at the top of every member's home screen. Up to six banners, each with a title, subtitle, emoji and colour.



Banners. Edit the fields and the preview updates; tap Save banners to publish.

1. Edit the **Title** (keep it under about 24 characters), the **Subtitle** (one line), the **Emoji** and the **Colour**.
2. Use + Add banner for a new one (maximum 6) or Remove to delete one.
3. Tap Save banners. Members see the new set the next time their home screen refreshes — usually within seconds.

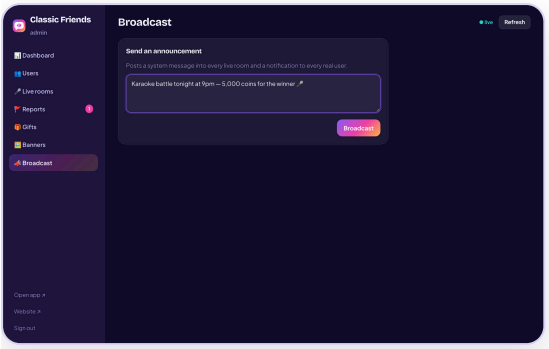
Ideas that perform: weekend gift carnival with double XP, karaoke or poetry battles with a coin prize, "Family week", new-host spotlight, a festival greeting (Diwali, Eid, Onam, Pongal). Change at least one banner every week so the home screen never looks stale.

📝 **Banners are promises**
If a banner announces a prize, make sure someone on the team grants it (Users → + coins) and posts the winners in a broadcast.

CHAPTER 9

Broadcast

One message to everyone: a system line in every live room's chat and a notification in every member's inbox.



Broadcast. Up to 200 characters. Tap Broadcast to send; there is no undo.

Good uses

- Event start: "Karaoke battle starts now in Tamil pasanga singing 🎤"
- Winners: "Congrats Harini — top singer of the week, 5,000 coins 🏆"
- Maintenance: "We restart the server at 03:00 for 5 minutes."
- Safety reminders: "Staff never ask for OTPs or payment details."

Etiquette

- At most two or three per day. Broadcasts interrupt conversations.
- Write in the languages your community speaks; keep it short.
- Never broadcast anything about a specific report or ban.

CHAPTER 10

Running the server

What the owner needs to know about the machine behind the console. Deployment to the internet is covered step by step in `docs/DEPLOYMENT.md`.

10.1 Start, stop, restart

Task	Command (in the project folder)
Install (first time)	`npm install`
Start	`npm start` → app at port 3000, console at `/admin/`
Start with settings	`ADMIN_TOKEN=secret BOTS=0 START_COINS=200 npm start`
Stop	Ctrl + C in the terminal (or `pm2 stop classic-friends` on a server)
Health check	Open `/healthz` — it answers `{"ok":true}` with the uptime in seconds

10.2 Settings (environment variables)

Name	Default	Meaning
`PORT`	3000	Network port.
`ADMIN_TOKEN`	classicfriends-admin	The console password. Change it before going live; restart to apply.
`BOTS`	70	Simulated people. Set 0 for a real community, or a small number (10–20) while it grows.
`START_COINS`	1000	Welcome coins for every new account. 100–200 is sensible once payments are live.

10.3 What is saved, and where

- **Member accounts** (name, coins, diamonds, level, items, friends) are saved to `server/data/users.json` every 30 seconds and on shutdown, and restored on the next start. Back this file up daily.
- **Rooms, chats, moments, reports, banner edits and gift edits** live in memory and are lost on restart in this version. Members simply open new rooms; banners and gift prices return to the defaults in `shared/engine.js` and `shared/catalog.js` — so make lasting changes there too.
- For a production community, connect a database as described in `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`.

10.4 Rotating the admin token

1. Choose a long random token (20+ characters).
2. Set `ADMIN_TOKEN` in your hosting dashboard or `.env` file.
3. Restart the server. Every console session is signed out automatically.
4. Share the new token privately with the people who still need it.



Incident checklist

If something is wrong (abuse wave, exploit, outage): 1) broadcast a short notice, 2) end affected rooms, 3) ban the accounts involved, 4) if needed stop the server, 5) write down what happened and when. Fix the cause before restarting with bots off.

CHAPTER 11

Daily, weekly and monthly routines

A small team can run Classic Friends well with these habits.

Every shift (10 minutes)

- [ ] Dashboard: online, live rooms, on mic, coins today. Note anything unusual.
- [ ] Reports: clear everything open. Underage and scam reports first.
- [ ] Live rooms: skim the names and hosts; open anything that looks off.
- [ ] Reply to support emails about coins, purchases and accounts.

Every week

- [ ] Refresh at least one banner; plan the weekend event and its prize budget.
- [ ] Pay out or announce event winners with a broadcast; grant prizes on the Users page.
- [ ] Look at the top gifters and top rooms — thank the hosts, spot accounts that look like fraud (huge coin balances with no purchases).
- [ ] Back up `server/data/users.json` somewhere safe.

Every month

- [ ] Review gift prices and coin packs against what members actually buy.
- [ ] Settle host payouts (diamonds → money) according to your Terms.
- [ ] Rotate the admin token if anyone has left the team.
- [ ] Read the moderation log for patterns and update the policy in Chapter 6 if needed.

CHAPTER 12

Economy reference

The numbers behind coins, diamonds, XP and VIP, as configured in `shared/catalog.js`.

How value moves

Event	Sender / buyer	Receiver
Gift of N coins	−N coins, +N XP, +N Wealth (daily/weekly/monthly rankings)	+0.5 N diamonds, +N Charm
Lucky gift	As above, plus a random return: 30 % nothing, 30 % 1×, 30 % 2×, 8 % 10×, 2 % 50× the price	As above
Diamond exchange	100 diamonds → 70 coins	—
Store item	−price, +price/2 XP; item lasts 30 days	—
VIP purchase	−price, +price XP; 30 days, extendable	—
Lucky wheel	−10 coins; prizes 0 / 5 / 10 / 20 / 50 / 100 / 500 with weights 30 / 25 / 20 / 12 / 8 / 4 / 1	—
Lucky bag	−total coins, +total XP	Random shares to whoever taps first
Check-in streak	+10 / 20 / 30 / 50 / 80 / 120 / 200 coins on days 1–7	—
Daily tasks	+20 to +50 coins each, up to 220 per day	—

Coin packs

Pack	Coins	Bonus	INR	AED	USD
Starter	100	—	89	3.99	0.99
Small	500	+50	449	19.99	4.99
Popular	1,000	+200	899	39.99	9.99
Big	2,500	+500	2,099	94.99	24.99
Large	5,000	+1,500	4,299	189.99	49.99
Best value	10,000	+5,000	8,499	379.99	99.99

Prices are placeholders — set your own in `shared/catalog.js → COIN_PACKS` and pick the currency in `BRAND.currency`.

Levels and VIP

Levels 1–100

XP needed for level L = 100 × $L^{1.8}$ (level 2 at 348 XP, level 10 at 6,310, level 30 at 45,600, level 50 at 114,000). Badge colours change at 10, 20, 30, 40, 50 and 70.

VIP 1–7

Bronze 499 · Silver 999 · Gold 2,499 · Platinum 4,999 · Diamond 9,999 · Royal 19,999 · Supreme 49,999 coins per 30 days. Each tier unlocks one exclusive gift and extra perks (entry effects, kick immunity, hidden visits, custom ID).

CHAPTER 13

Admin API reference

Everything the console does is also available to scripts, so you can connect dashboards, alerts or a payments webhook. Every request needs the header `x-admin-token: <your token>`.

Endpoint	Does
`GET /api/admin/stats`	Dashboard tiles, top rooms, top gifters.
`GET /api/admin/users?q=&page=`	Search users (25 per page).
`POST /api/admin/users/:id`	Body: `{ banned, vip, coins, grantCoins, level }` — any subset.
`GET /api/admin/rooms`	Live rooms with seats, members and messages.
`POST /api/admin/rooms/:id/close`	End a room.
`GET /api/admin/reports`	All reports, newest first.
`POST /api/admin/reports/:id`	Body: `{ action: "resolved" | "warned" | "ban" }`.
`GET / POST /api/admin/gifts`	Read the catalog / update or add a gift `{ id, name, emoji, price, cat, tier, active }`.
`GET / POST /api/admin/banners`	Read / replace the banner list `{ banners: [...] }`.
`POST /api/admin/broadcast`	Body: `{ text }`.
`GET /healthz`	Uptime check (no token needed).

Example — grant 500 coins from a terminal:

```
curl -X POST https://your-domain/api/admin/users/4821934 \
  -H "x-admin-token: YOUR_TOKEN" -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"grantCoins":500}'
```

The member app talks to the server over Socket.IO with a whitelist of actions; the full event list is in `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`.

CHAPTER 14

Troubleshooting

When the console or the server misbehaves.

Symptom	Cause and fix
"That token was not accepted"	The token differs from `ADMIN_TOKEN` on the server. Check for spaces; if the server was started without the variable, the default applies.
Status shows ● offline / "Could not reach the server"	The server is stopped or unreachable. Open `/healthz`; if it fails, start the server (`npm start` or `pm2 restart classic-friends`) and check the hosting dashboard.
Console signs you out by itself	The token was rotated and the server restarted. Sign in with the new token.
A member says a price or new gift is not visible	Catalog changes reach the app on sign-in. Ask them to sign out and in, or reload the page.
Banner edits disappeared	The server restarted; banners and gift edits are in memory in this version. Re-enter them, and put permanent ones in `shared/engine.js` / `shared/catalog.js`.
Members lost coins after a restart	The snapshot file `server/data/users.json` was deleted or the host has no persistent disk. Restore from backup; use a persistent disk or a database.
Dashboard numbers look inflated	Bots are counted. Run with `BOTS=0` for real figures.
Ending a room did not remove someone	Their connection lagged. They are removed when it reconnects; a ban removes them immediately regardless.
Voice does not work for members on the live site	Browsers allow microphones only on https://. Make sure the site has a valid certificate (see DEPLOYMENT.md).

Support: hello@classicfriends.app · Keep this guide with your team's moderation log and the server credentials in a password manager.